

06

Closed Spanish Maneuvering

Knight journeys, bishop preservation, and the logic behind moves that look backward.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will translate slow-looking maneuvers into concrete destinations, breaks, and prophylactic effects.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate candidates for the side to move, identify the opponent's strongest resource, and choose the resulting structure you can explain. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 031 | PAGE 4

Decode: The Breyer knight retreat

A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

LESSON 032 | PAGE 8

Play: The Breyer knight retreat

A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

LESSON 033 | PAGE 12

Decode: White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey

Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

LESSON 034 | PAGE 16

Play: White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey

Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

LESSON 035 | PAGE 20

Decode: The Spanish light bishop

Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

LESSON 036 | PAGE 24

Play: The Spanish light bishop

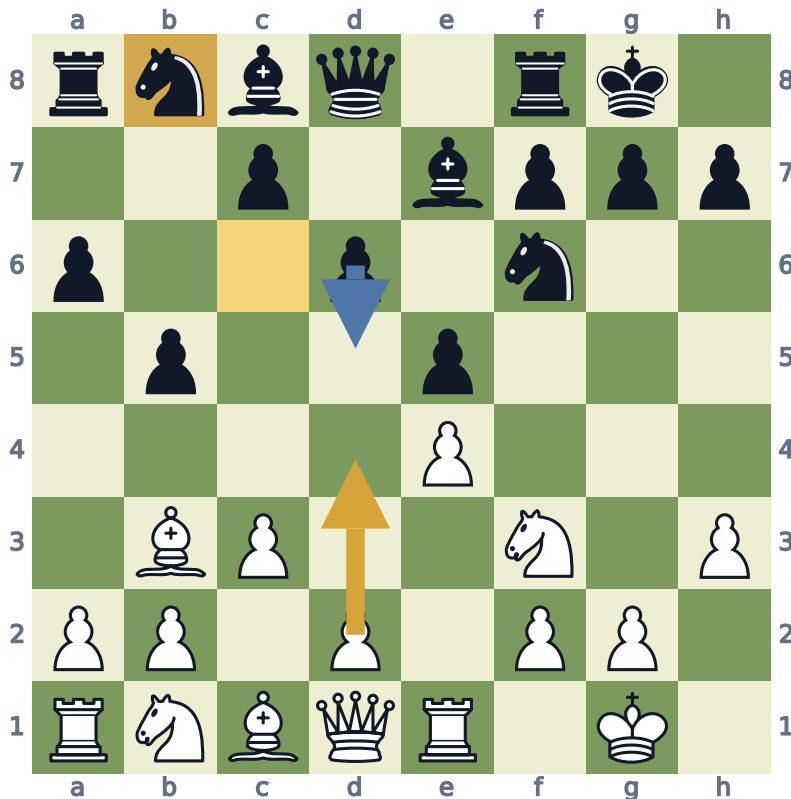
Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

VOLUME OBJECTIVE

You will translate slow-looking maneuvers into concrete destinations, breaks, and prophylactic effects.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The Breyer knight retreat



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Nb8 clears c6, reroutes to d7, supports e5, and prepares coordinated ...Bf8 and ...g6; the retreat solves several future problems.

DECISION RULE

What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Complete the reroute, defend e5 economically, and seek ...d5 when the pieces support it.

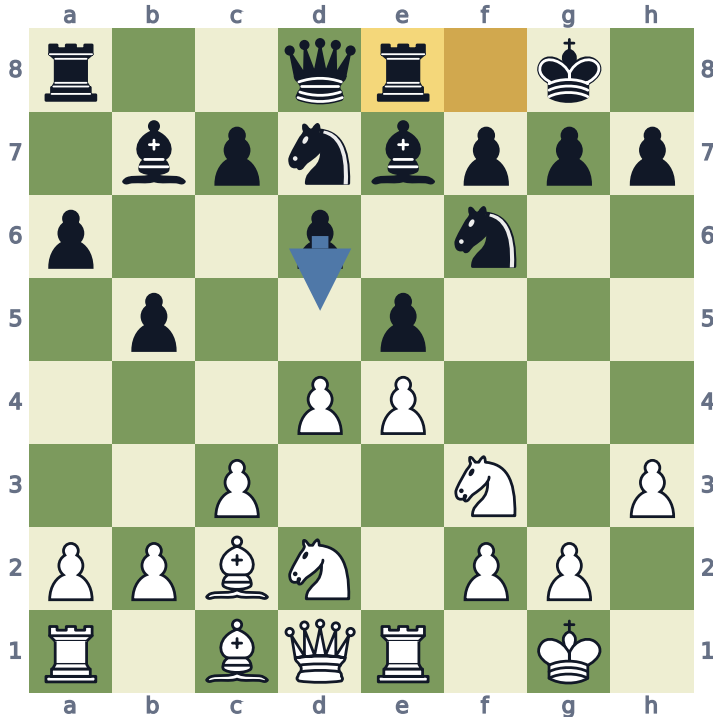
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White uses the time for d4, Nbd2-f1-g3, and queenside space, trying to make the reroute too slow.

MEMORY RULE | A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



WHITE'S PLAN

White uses the time for d4, Nbd2-f1-g3, and queenside space, trying to make the reroute too slow.

CUE

...Nb8 clears c6, reroutes to d7, supports e5, and prepares coordinated ...Bf8 and ...g6; the retreat solves several future problems.

BLACK'S PLAN

Complete the reroute, defend e5 economically, and seek ...d5 when the pieces support it.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

FAILURE MODE

Imitating ...Nb8 without knowing whether the Breyer structure and timing are present.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

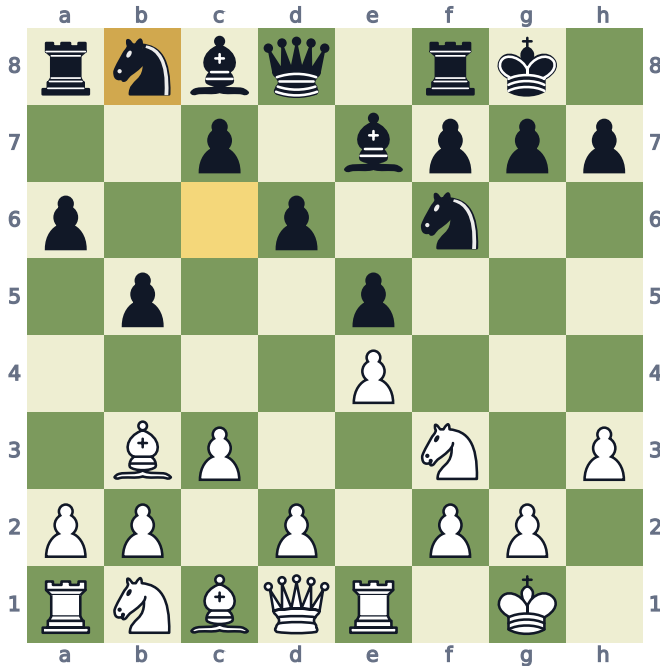
RULE | A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- h3: White prevents a pin and supports the coming central plan at the cost of one tempo.
- Nb8: Black reroutes a knight to b8; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Nb8 clears c6, reroutes to d7, supports e5, and prepares coordinated ...Bf8 and ...g6; the retreat solves several future problems.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated? White's resource is: White uses the time for d4, Nbd2-f1-g3, and queenside space, trying to make the reroute too slow. The line fails as a template when: Imitating ...Nb8 without knowing whether the Breyer structure and timing are present.

STORE THIS | A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

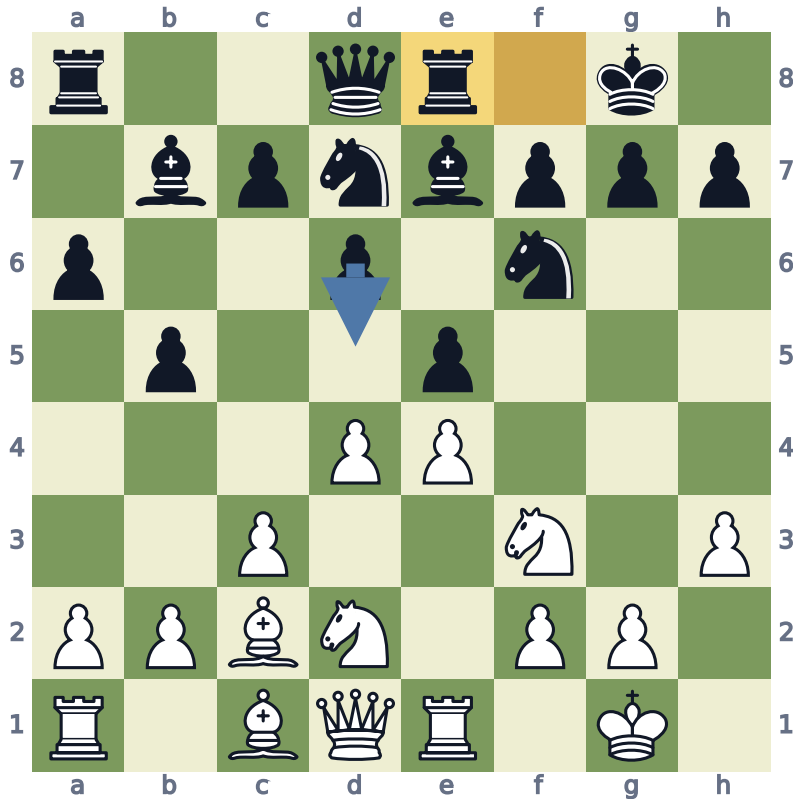
1. ...Nb8 clears c6, reroutes to d7, supports e5, and prepares coordinated ...Bf8 and ...g6; the retreat solves several future problems. 2. Complete the reroute, defend e5 economically, and seek ...d5 when the pieces support it. 3. White uses the time for d4, Nbd2-f1-g3, and queenside space, trying to make the reroute too slow. 4. What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated? 5. Imitating ...Nb8 without knowing whether the Breyer structure and timing are present.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The Breyer knight retreat



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Nb8 clears c6, reroutes to d7, supports e5, and prepares coordinated ...Bf8 and ...g6; the retreat solves several future problems.

DECISION RULE

What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Complete the reroute, defend e5 economically, and seek ...d5 when the pieces support it.

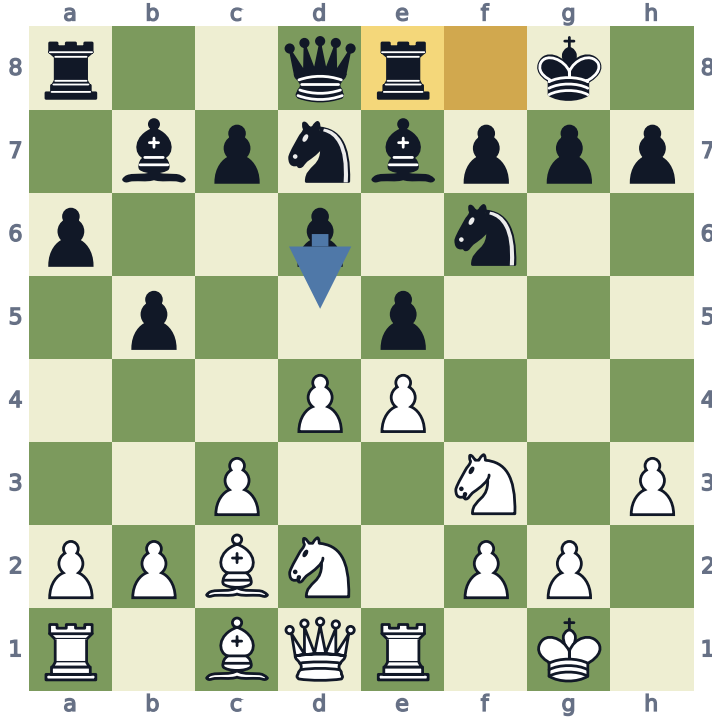
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White uses the time for d4, Nbd2-f1-g3, and queenside space, trying to make the reroute too slow.

MEMORY RULE | A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Nb8 clears c6, reroutes to d7, supports e5, and prepares coordinated ...Bf8 and ...g6; the retreat solves several future problems.

BLACK'S PLAN

Complete the reroute, defend e5 economically, and seek ...d5 when the pieces support it.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White uses the time for d4, Nbd2-f1-g3, and queenside space, trying to make the reroute too slow.

FAILURE MODE

Imitating ...Nb8 without knowing whether the Breyer structure and timing are present.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

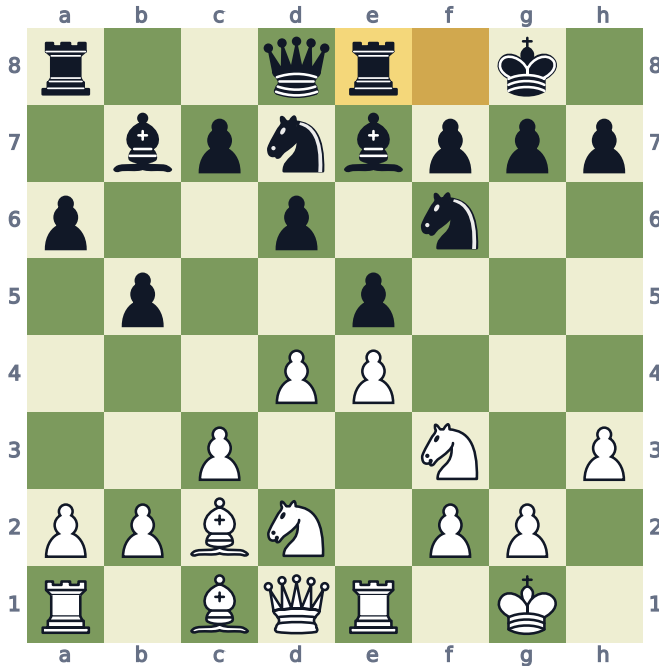
RULE | A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8



- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bc2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Re8: Black places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Nb8 clears c6, reroutes to d7, supports e5, and prepares coordinated ...Bf8 and ...g6; the retreat solves several future problems.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated? White's resource is: White uses the time for d4, Nbd2-f1-g3, and queenside space, trying to make the reroute too slow. The line fails as a template when: Imitating ...Nb8 without knowing whether the Breyer structure and timing are present.

STORE THIS | A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

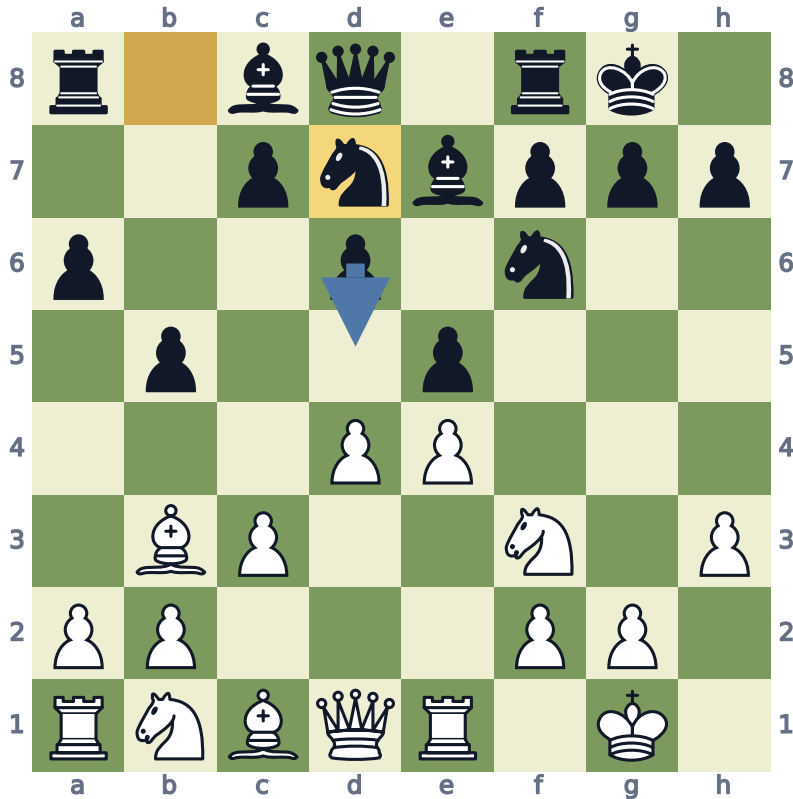
1. ...Nb8 clears c6, reroutes to d7, supports e5, and prepares coordinated ...Bf8 and ...g6; the retreat solves several future problems. 2. Complete the reroute, defend e5 economically, and seek ...d5 when the pieces support it. 3. White uses the time for d4, Nbd2-f1-g3, and queenside space, trying to make the reroute too slow. 4. What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated? 5. Imitating ...Nb8 without knowing whether the Breyer structure and timing are present.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 24 plies from memory, then replay: 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The knight reaches g3 where it supports f5, h5, e4, and f1 while leaving the c-pawn's work intact.

DECISION RULE

What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Black restrains f5 and uses ...g6, ...c5, or ...d5 before White completes a kingside buildup.

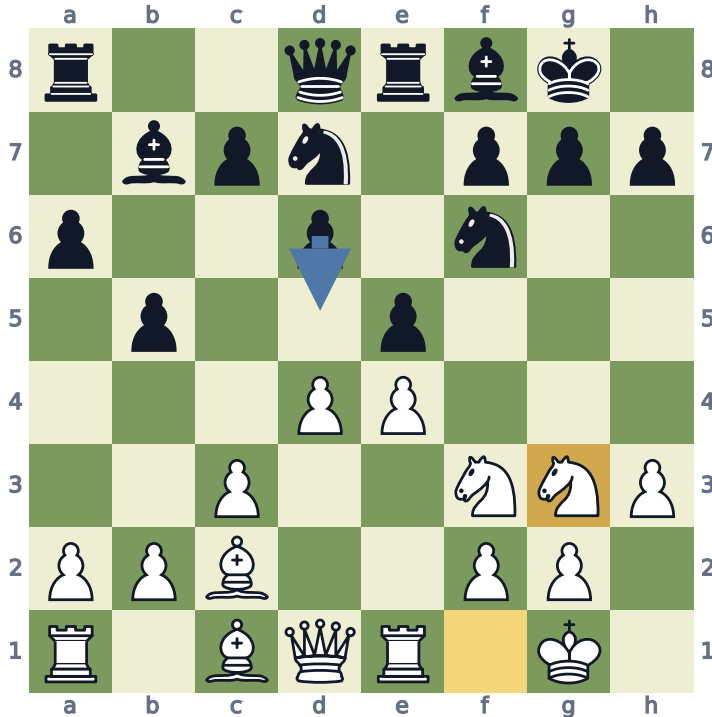
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White accumulates pieces toward the king while preserving central tension.

MEMORY RULE | Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The knight reaches g3 where it supports f5, h5, e4, and f1 while leaving the c-pawn's work intact.

BLACK'S PLAN

Black restrains f5 and uses ...g6, ...c5, or ...d5 before White completes a kingside buildup.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S PLAN

White accumulates pieces toward the king while preserving central tension.

FAILURE MODE

Completing a long maneuver while the center changes and the destination loses relevance.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

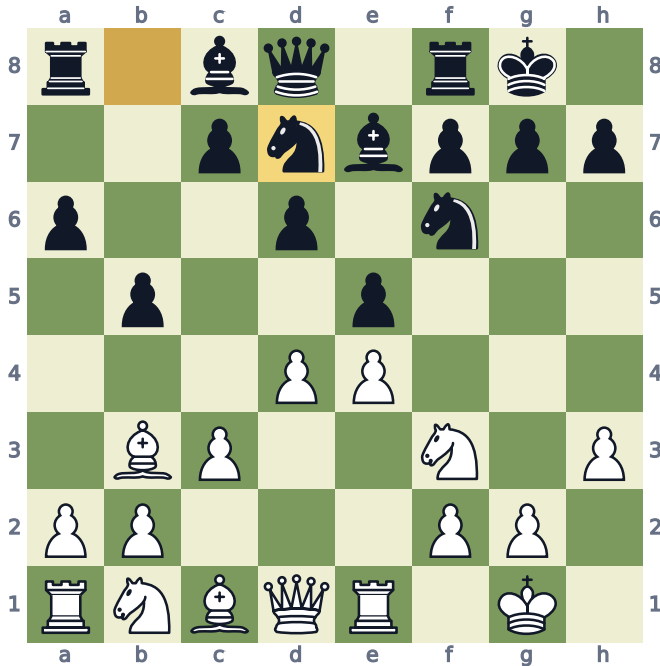
RULE | Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8 14. Ng3



- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- h3: White prevents a pin and supports the coming central plan at the cost of one tempo.
- Nb8: Black reroutes a knight to b8; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The knight reaches g3 where it supports f5, h5, e4, and f1 while leaving the c-pawn's work intact.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now? White's resource is: White accumulates pieces toward the king while preserving central tension. The line fails as a template when: Completing a long maneuver while the center changes and the destination loses relevance.

STORE THIS | Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

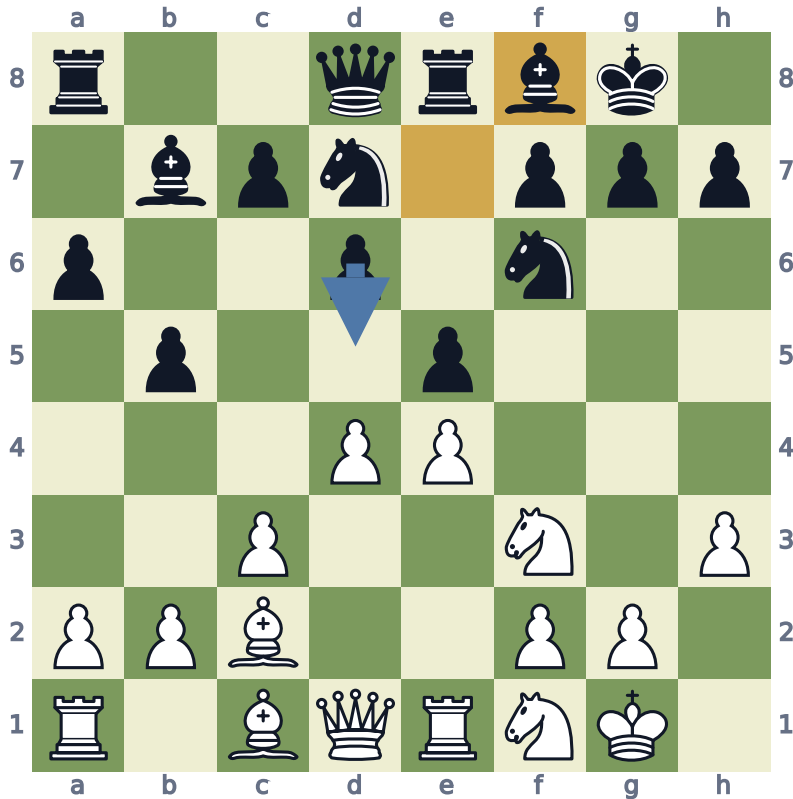
1. The knight reaches g3 where it supports f5, h5, e4, and f1 while leaving the c-pawn's work intact. 2. Black restrains f5 and uses ...g6, ...c5, or ...d5 before White completes a kingside buildup. 3. White accumulates pieces toward the king while preserving central tension. 4. What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now? 5. Completing a long maneuver while the center changes and the destination loses relevance.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The knight reaches g3 where it supports f5, h5, e4, and f1 while leaving the c-pawn's work intact.

DECISION RULE

What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Black restrains f5 and uses ...g6, ...c5, or ...d5 before White completes a kingside buildup.

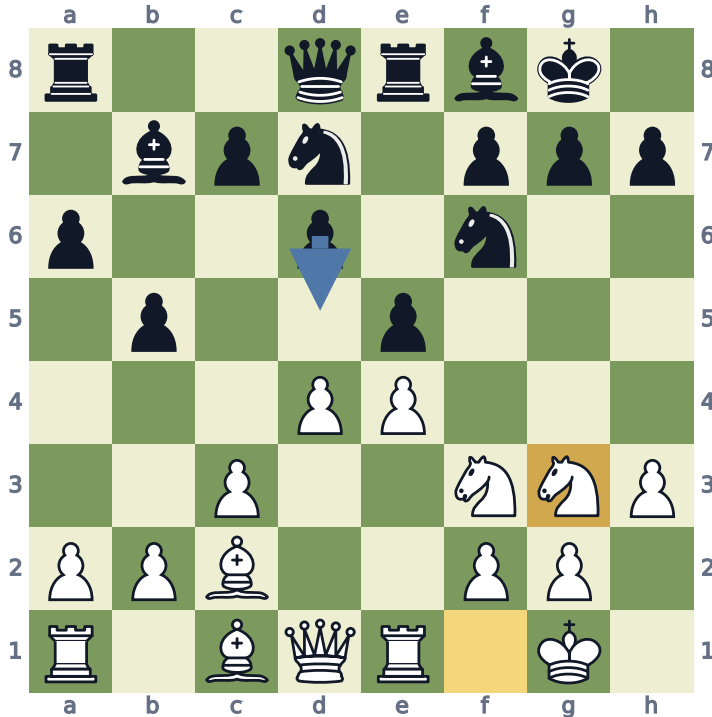
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White accumulates pieces toward the king while preserving central tension.

MEMORY RULE | Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The knight reaches g3 where it supports f5, h5, e4, and f1 while leaving the c-pawn's work intact.

BLACK'S PLAN

Black restrains f5 and uses ...g6, ...c5, or ...d5 before White completes a kingside buildup.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S PLAN

White accumulates pieces toward the king while preserving central tension.

FAILURE MODE

Completing a long maneuver while the center changes and the destination loses relevance.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

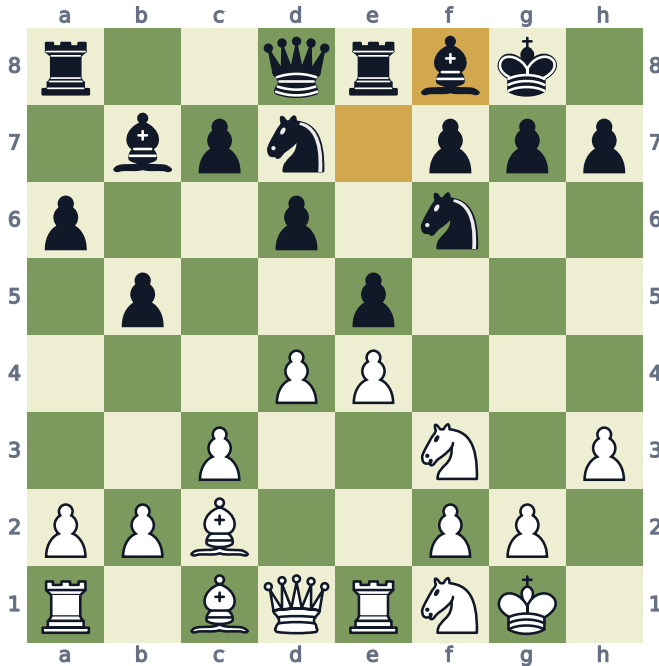
RULE | Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8 14. Ng3



- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bc2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Re8: Black places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bf8: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The knight reaches g3 where it supports f5, h5, e4, and f1 while leaving the c-pawn's work intact.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now? White's resource is: White accumulates pieces toward the king while preserving central tension. The line fails as a template when: Completing a long maneuver while the center changes and the destination loses relevance.

STORE THIS | Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

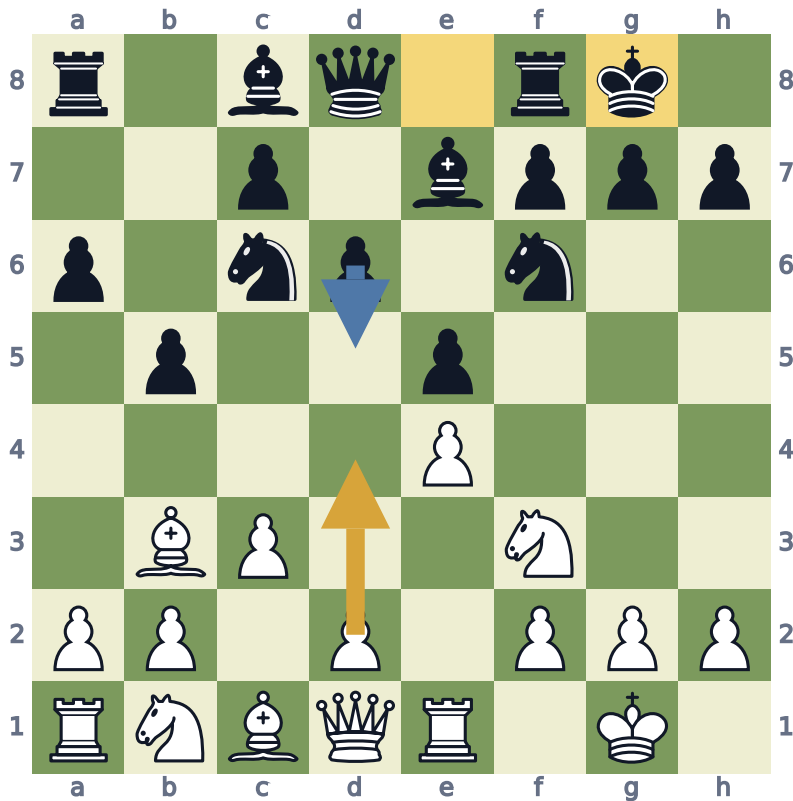
1. The knight reaches g3 where it supports f5, h5, e4, and f1 while leaving the c-pawn's work intact. 2. Black restrains f5 and uses ...g6, ...c5, or ...d5 before White completes a kingside buildup. 3. White accumulates pieces toward the king while preserving central tension. 4. What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now? 5. Completing a long maneuver while the center changes and the destination loses relevance.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 26 plies from memory, then replay: 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The Spanish light bishop



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The bishop retreats to c2 to preserve itself and aim at h7, but it can become buried behind e4 unless the center opens.

DECISION RULE

Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Black blocks or contests the diagonal and uses queenside space while monitoring kingside sacrifices.

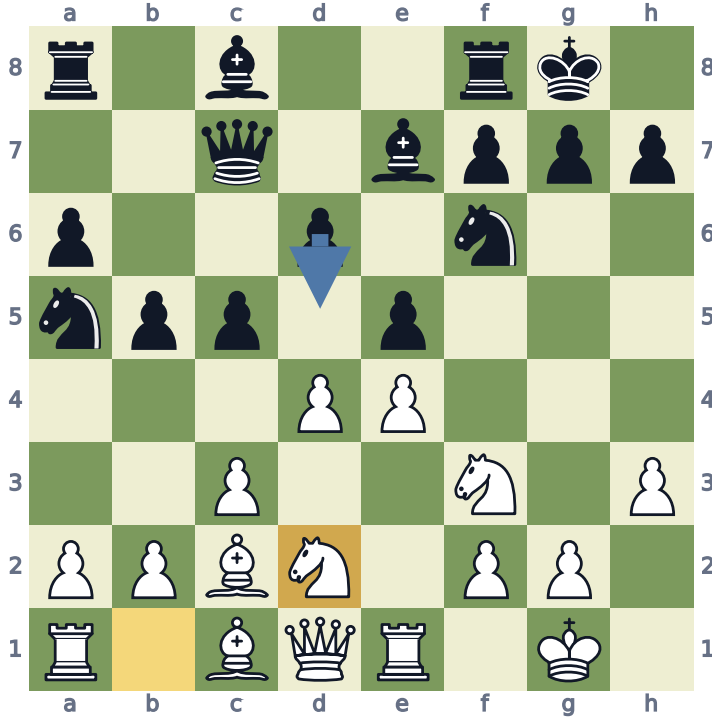
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White opens the b1-h7 diagonal with d4 and sometimes e5, then coordinates queen and bishop against h7.

MEMORY RULE | Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The bishop retreats to c2 to preserve itself and aim at h7, but it can become buried behind e4 unless the center opens.

BLACK'S PLAN

Black blocks or contests the diagonal and uses queenside space while monitoring kingside sacrifices.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens the b1-h7 diagonal with d4 and sometimes e5, then coordinates queen and bishop against h7.

FAILURE MODE

Valuing the bishop pair abstractly while the c2 bishop has no line or target.

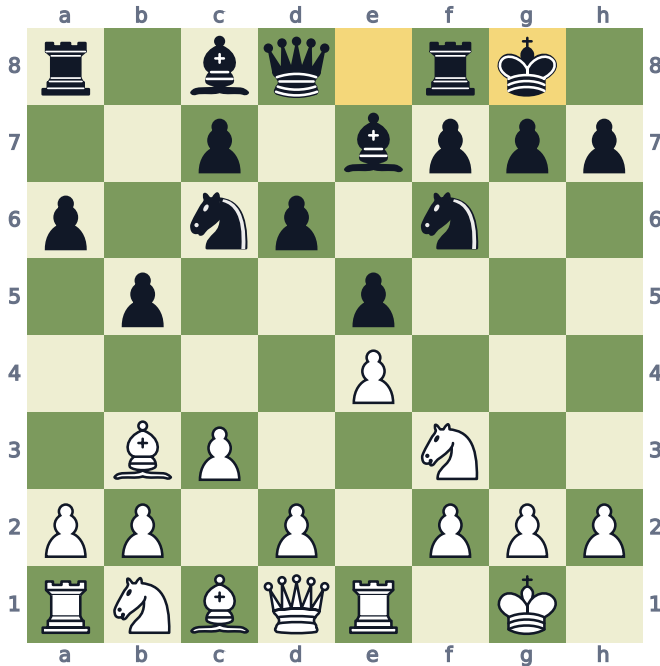
DECISION TEST

Ask: Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

Move-by-move meaning

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Na5 10. Bc2 c5 11. d4 Qc7 12. Nbd2



- 22

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

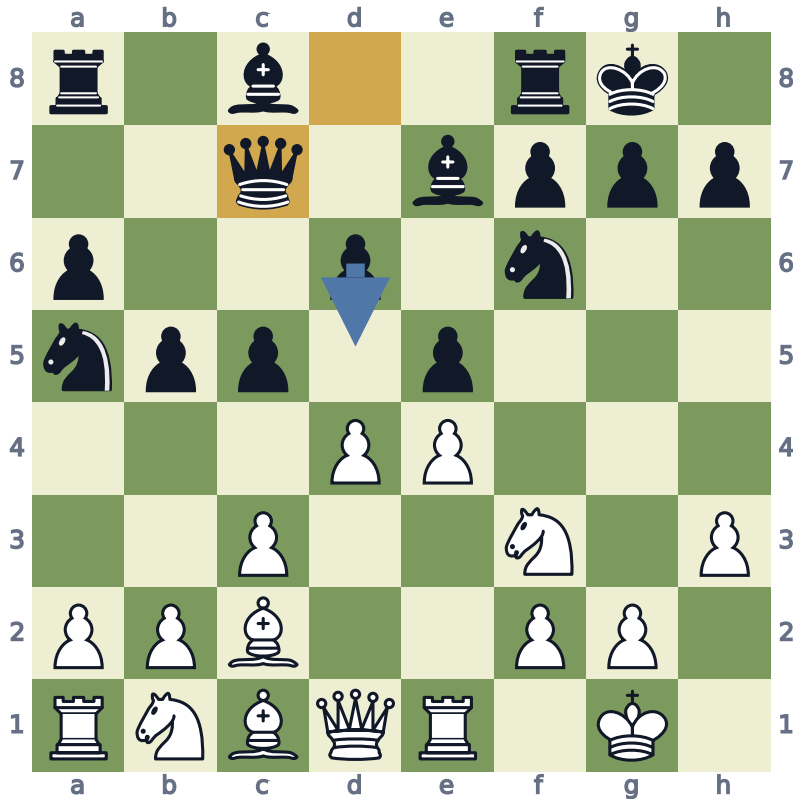
1. The bishop retreats to c2 to preserve itself and aim at h7, but it can become buried behind e4 unless the center opens. 2. Black blocks or contests the diagonal and uses queenside space while monitoring kingside sacrifices. 3. White opens the b1-h7 diagonal with d4 and sometimes e5, then coordinates queen and bishop against h7. 4. Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat? 5. Valuing the bishop pair abstractly while the c2 bishop has no line or target.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The Spanish light bishop



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The bishop retreats to c2 to preserve itself and aim at h7, but it can become buried behind e4 unless the center opens.

DECISION RULE

Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Black blocks or contests the diagonal and uses queenside space while monitoring kingside sacrifices.

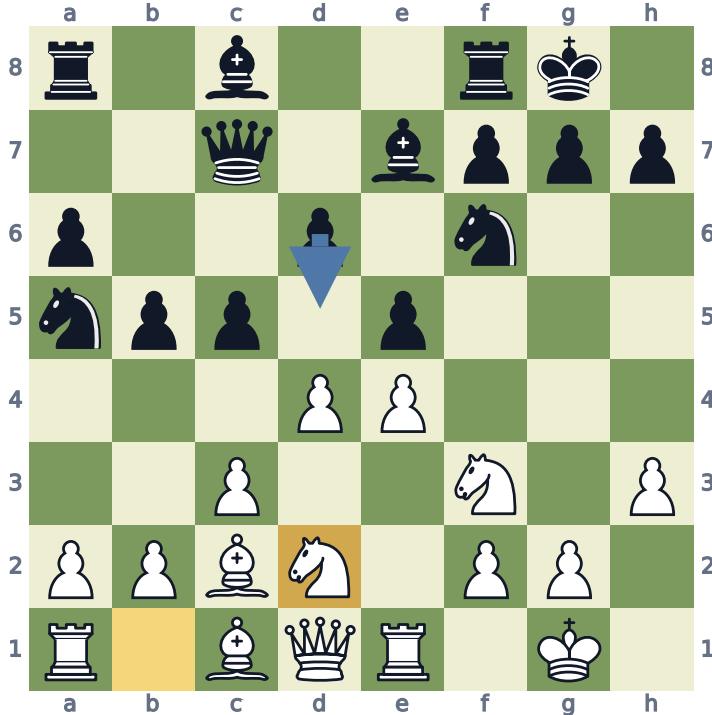
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White opens the b1-h7 diagonal with d4 and sometimes e5, then coordinates queen and bishop against h7.

MEMORY RULE | Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The bishop retreats to c2 to preserve itself and aim at h7, but it can become buried behind e4 unless the center opens.

BLACK'S PLAN

Black blocks or contests the diagonal and uses queenside space while monitoring kingside sacrifices.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens the b1-h7 diagonal with d4 and sometimes e5, then coordinates queen and bishop against h7.

FAILURE MODE

Valuing the bishop pair abstractly while the c2 bishop has no line or target.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

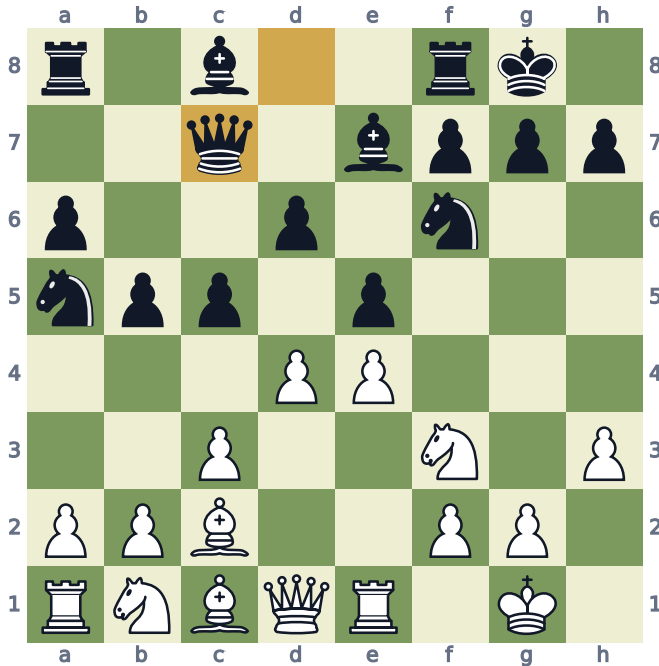
RULE | Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Na5 10. Bc2 c5 11. d4 Qc7 12. Nbd2



- h3: White prevents a pin and supports the coming central plan at the cost of one tempo.
- Na5: Black reroutes a knight to a5; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bc2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- c5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- Qc7: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The bishop retreats to c2 to preserve itself and aim at h7, but it can become buried behind e4 unless the center opens.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat? White's resource is: White opens the b1-h7 diagonal with d4 and sometimes e5, then coordinates queen and bishop against h7. The line fails as a template when: Valuing the bishop pair abstractly while the c2 bishop has no line or target.

STORE THIS | Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. The bishop retreats to c2 to preserve itself and aim at h7, but it can become buried behind e4 unless the center opens. 2. Black blocks or contests the diagonal and uses queenside space while monitoring kingside sacrifices. 3. White opens the b1-h7 diagonal with d4 and sometimes e5, then coordinates queen and bishop against h7. 4. Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat? 5. Valuing the bishop pair abstractly while the c2 bishop has no line or target.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. h3 Na5 10. Bc2 c5 11. d4 Qc7

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 031 Decode: The Breyer knight retreat

Prompt: What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated?

Recall: A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

LESSON 032 Play: The Breyer knight retreat

Prompt: What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated?

Recall: A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

LESSON 033 Decode: White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey

Prompt: What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now?

Recall: Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

LESSON 034 Play: White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey

Prompt: What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now?

Recall: Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

LESSON 035 Decode: The Spanish light bishop

Prompt: Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat?

Recall: Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

LESSON 036 Play: The Spanish light bishop

Prompt: Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat?

Recall: Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's plan, one candidate for the side to move, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The Breyer knight retreat

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8

Decision: What new square and pawn break become possible because c6 was vacated?

Memory: A backward move is strong when it clears one square and improves two future moves.

CARD 2

White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Nb8 10. d4 Nbd7 11. Nbd2 Bb7 12. Bc2 Re8 13. Nf1 Bf8 14. Ng3

Decision: What attacking or central break does Ng3 make possible, and what can Black challenge now?

Memory: Recheck the board at every station of a maneuver; the destination is not guaranteed.

CARD 3

The Spanish light bishop

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Na5 10. Bc2 c5 11. d4 Qc7 12. Nbd2

Decision: Is the bishop currently active, and which pawn break turns its hidden diagonal into a threat?

Memory: Preserve the Spanish bishop only if you can eventually open its diagonal.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
031 Decode: The Breyer knight retreat	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
032 Play: The Breyer knight retreat	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
033 Decode: White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
034 Play: White's Nbd2-f1-g3 journey	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
035 Decode: The Spanish light bishop	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
036 Play: The Spanish light bishop	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name both sides' strongest plans, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.